

hours with neither of them saying a word, then got off the freeway to get some gas. He filled the tank, paid for the gas, and headed down the freeway again.

The first words his wife spoke were, "Do you know you're headed in the wrong direction?"

He said, "Boy, did that make me mad." So I told her, "Don't you think I've got enough sense that with a Ph.D. I know which way to go?" As he drove on, he quickly realized that he *was* going in the wrong direction. But he drove on 30 minutes more, wondering, "How can I turn this car around without her realizing it?"

After that, he grasped God's plan in his marriage—balance. Together they functioned pretty well. Apart, they looked pretty foolish, especially him.

He told me they still don't agree on everything. "But that's OK," he said, "because now we realize we're not supposed to." By communicating even their differences, they are able to reach a better decision than either can independently. "Now when we discuss something," he said, "do you know what I find? My best is her worst and her best is my worst. But somewhere in between, we always find a point we can agree on. As a result, we have become much closer. We have learned that neither of us is ever totally right. Now we have communications, not combat."

WHO IS THE SPENDTHRIFT?

Let me correct a common misconception made in most marriages. The majority of spending in a marriage is *not* done by the wife. Under an impulse, a woman will buy too much food and too many clothes. Under the same impulse, her husband will buy a new car, a motor home, or an airplane. We men don't buy often, but when we do, we buy big-ticket items. The majority of indebtedness in most marriages comes as a result of the husband's spending.

Husbands, I would suggest some simple impulse-buying rules. First, don't ever buy anything that isn't budgeted, unless you wait at least 30 days. Second, get at least 3 different